

The interface looks pretty sparse compared to the other software we've reviewed in this section. It's probably the simplest and most accessible of all. Again, there are two separate programs—the scanner and the resident protector, as it should be. The actual scanning program isn't that sparse on tabs, and has a whole lot of options: how to repair a file, scheduling of scans, the Internet update, and much, much more.



AntiVir has the sparsest main screen of all the three

There's no immediate prompt for virus definition updates, nor does the program warn you if your definitions are out of date. There also wasn't any indication that one could schedule automatic updates. Apparently you can, though.

Under 'Internet Update', there's a helpful table: under one column it says "on your PC," and under the other, "on the Internet". It lists out the program version, the version of the virus definitions, and more, so you can see at a glance what's on the Internet that's not on your computer!

In AntiVir, you have the option of scanning all files, or using a file extension list. Using a file extension list (provided you know how to do it properly) can significantly reduce scanning time. Though other programs in this section have this feature, it's not as patent and accessible as in AntiVir. There are options aplenty in the scanning program, like we said. Scanning options go as detailed as scanning on file read, file write, or file read and write.

There's a tab called "Action if file not repaired." Here, of course, you specify what action to take if AntiVir can't repair a particular file.